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25 Relocation *Tips*

A new job. A growing family. Moving closer to kids and grandkids. The reasons for relocating vary, but every one leads to a new place to call home.

Whether you're moving across town or across the country, uprooting your life takes planning. From organizing movers to changing your address, use these 25 tips to plan, prepare and pack for your move.

1. **Give yourself time to prepare.** Start planning up to six months before your move.
2. **Make plans for your new life.** Think about the lifestyle you want, then research the area's gyms, restaurants, parks, trails and other amenities.
3. **Sort and purge.** Decide what to keep and what to let go, and plan special packing for fragile or valuable items.
4. **Order moving supplies.** Stock up on boxes, bubble wrap, tape and containers.
5. **Research movers.** Get written estimates. Also look at portable storage containers, which let you pack at your own pace and have everything delivered to your new home on your timeline.
6. **Talk with your kids.** Share what's happening and involve them in decisions to ease the anxiety of a move.
7. **Get kids excited with visuals.** Make a Pinterest board of the new city and neighborhood, and another with design ideas for their new room.
8. **Take a test drive.** If the new area is within driving distance, visit with the kids before moving day.
9. **Get your pets ready.** Help pets get used to their carrier about a month before the move.
10. **Forward medical records.** Arrange for records to be sent to your new health care providers.
11. **Get your pet's medical records.** Ask your vet for your pet's history or an interstate health certificate.
12. **Set your kids up at their new school.** Transfer school records, and watch enrollment dates if you plan on a charter or private school.
13. **Refill prescriptions.** If you can, fill them early so you're covered through your first month after the move.

Packing and moving day

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14 **Make a packing supplies basket.** Keep tape, markers and scissors in one place so you're never searching.

15 **Create a moving checklist.** Spread tasks out over weeks to avoid last-minute chaos.

16 **Use up what you don't want to move.** Work through perishable food and cleaning supplies.

17 **Ask for help.** Friends and family can lighten the load.

18 **Get plenty of rest.** Good sleep keeps you productive and lowers stress.

19 **Finish packing early.** Be done a few days before the move, and pack suitcases with essentials.

20 **Pack your jewelry.** Egg cartons and toilet paper rolls keep pieces organized and untangled.

21 **Photograph your electronics.** Snap a picture of the cords before unplugging so setup is easy.

22 **Keep clothes from wrinkling.** Slip a garbage bag over hanging clothes.

23 **Defrost the freezer.** If you're moving the refrigerator, defrost it at least 24 hours before moving day.

24 **Pack the essentials.** Make an essentials box for each family member, pets included.

25 **Arrange for a sitter.** Line up child or pet care for moving day to lower stress and keep everyone safe.

> **Moving to Utah?** My full relocation guide covers how to pick an area, what to expect when buying here, and how I help out-of-state buyers. Scan the code below or visit willdobesh.github.io/relocate.html.



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